The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Eye Disease

Āryākṣirogapraśamanisūtra · Toh 1018 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་མཐོ་ནད་རབ་ཏུ་ཞི་བར་བྱེད་པའི་མདོ།

The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Eye Disease, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Akṣirogapraśamanisūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa mig nad rab tu zhi bar byed pa'i mdo, is a brief scripture concerned with healing afflictions of the eyes. Set on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, it opens with the great yakṣa general known as the Black One approaching the Buddha and asking how eye diseases arising in that great city should be treated. In reply, the Buddha teaches a protective mantra, a short incantation to be recited for relief from such ailments, placing the text among the many short dhāraṇī and protective works that join Buddhist teaching with practical concerns for health and well-being. It is Toh 1018 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, the class of scriptures devoted to mantras and incantations.

In the language of India: ārya akṣirogapraśamanisūtra
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Eye Disease.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus have I heard at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain. Then the great yakṣa general, the Black One, went to where the Blessed One was. When he had arrived, he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if eye diseases arise here in the great city of Rājagṛha, how should they be treated?"

The Blessed One declared: "Black One, there are these words of the mantra for eye disease: tadyathā rudhire phuḥ rudhira akṣi phuḥ rudhira piṃgale phuḥ bāte phuḥ batele phuḥ hante phuḥ māṃsadundubhi phuḥ padma akṣi phuḥ padmadaṇḍa hiraṇīye phuḥ svāhā."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the great yakṣa general, the Black One, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This is the rite. One should recite the mantra seven times over a white thread and tie seven knots in it. One should recite it seven times over water and apply it with the hand; by doing so, the eye disease will be pacified.

This completes the Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Eye Disease.

Translator's Notes

• The yakṣa general's name, Nakpo, means "Black One." It probably renders the Sanskrit Kāla or Kṛṣṇa, but because the original cannot be fixed with confidence, the name is translated by its meaning.

In the rite, the verb rendered "tie" (dor) literally means "cast" or "leave." In this context it is taken to mean tying the knots in the thread.

The phrase "apply it with the hand" is a brief instruction. It is most naturally understood as applying the empowered water to the eyes by hand.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.